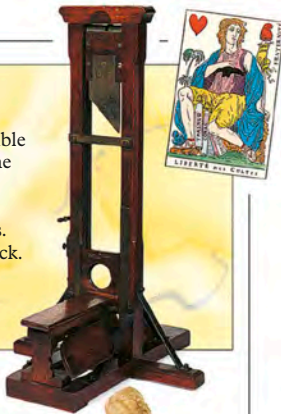




The guillotine

Anyone who was not loyal to the revolution faced arrest and possible death by guillotine. The guillotine cut off the heads of the victims. It was made of a heavy, sharp blade that fell between two posts. Death by guillotine was very quick. It caused less suffering than other methods of execution.



Victims of the guillotine rode to the place of execution in open carts, called tumbrels.



The revolutionaries wore a red hat that looked like a nightcap. It was decorated with a blue and white ribbon.

American revolution

In the 1770s, British colonists (settlers) in America grew sick of being ruled by the British king. They fought for their independence and won, setting up a Republic—a state without a king. The French revolutionaries were encouraged by the American success.



This painting shows colonists fighting the British in Massachusetts in 1775.

